LIVAROT PDO

THE BASICS

MAKE:	Soft
SUB MAKE:	Predominantly Rennet set cheese for further ripening
POST-MAKE:	Washed rind, Wrapped, Rolled or Processed
SUB POST-MAKE:	Unflavoured wash solution, Natural (leaf wrapped, wood or cloth girdle)
TYPICAL AGE PROFILE:	Two months
APPROXIMATE WEIGHT(S):	450-500g (Petit 200g and Grand 1.2kg versions also permitted)
GEOGRAPHICAL ORIGIN:	Normandy, France
PROTECTED STATUS:	PDO – must be made with cows' milk in Calvados, Orne or L'Eure department of Normandy
SPECIES OF MILKING ANIMAL:	Cow
BREED OF COW:	Normande
RAW/PASTEURISED MILK:	Examples of both depending on cheesemaker
VEGETARIAN/ANIMAL RENNET:	Typically animal rennet
COMMONLY ENCOUNTERED VARIATIONS:	N/A



THE STORY

Livarot is known as 'the Colonel' because it is encircled by three or five strips of a dried reed-like plant called sedge, which resemble the braids on a colonel's uniform denoting rank. Hailing from the town of the same name in Normandy, the cheese must be made with milk from Normande cows, which is high in butterfat and protein. The animals must also graze for at least six months outside on the lush grass that grows in the clay soil and maritime climate of the Pays d'Auge.

Livarot is made in small vats with a capacity of less than 320l to ensure that acidity and moisture are consistent throughout moulding. The cheeses are matured for at least 35 days and washed in salt water to encourage sticky orange bacteria on the rind. Cultures may be added to the solution as well as annatto, which helps colour the rind.

THE CHARACTER

The sticky, pungent rind of Livarot varies in colour from straw yellow to deep red, while the interior is supple with small holes. Flavours include dairy, floral and earthy notes.

PERFECT PARTNERS:

Cider or Calvados are the tipples of choice in Normandy or try a light fruity red, such as Chinon.

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